have earned him enemies as he was thought to have swung votes in the village in ISF's favour.

In May 2021, soon after the poll results were declared, a group of men had allegedly ransacked Anis's home, threatened to kill him and assaulted his uncle. They were allegedly led by a local panchayat office-bearer and a TMC booth-level leader. Anis sent a complaint to the police by post as he feared he was under watch. Friends recall a Facebook post by Anis around the time that he would 'embrace death' rather than 'sell himself to brokers'.

With public faith in the police shaken, there is a strong demand for the case to be handed over to the CBI. "How can we rely on the state police when men in uniform held me at gunpoint and killed my son?" asks Salaam. Villagers wonder why the local police station in-charge was allowed to go on long leave when questioning him could have revealed whether policemen had indeed visited Anis's home on the fateful night.

Politically active, Anis Khan was a vocal critic of the Mamata government and had taken part in the anti-CAA protests in 2019

Bengal has erupted against Anis's death, with both political parties and civil rights groups taking to the streets to demand justice. The protests may intensify. "More than 20 demonstrations by various groups have been held [in Kolkata]. Expect more in the days to come," says Mayukh Biswas, national general secretary of the left-wing Students' Federation of India (SFI).

Dipsita Dhar, SFI's all-India joint secretary, describes the protests as an "outcry for justice by sensible citizens". "The crime perpetrated is an atrocity on students by an anarchic and autocratic government," she says. A demonstration on February 26 in Amta was met with a lathi charge and 16 activists, including Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI) state secretary Meenakshi Mukherjee, were rounded up and charged with attempt to murder.

Not just students, Anis's death is also mobilising the local Muslim community. "We are condemning the incident at our masjids. We have assured Anis's family that we are with them and want the criminals to be arrested immediately," says a Muslim cleric from Bargachhia, camping 20 km away at Anis's village. Clerics from Furfura Sharif and other shrines have also been visiting the family.

Anis's mysterious death has revived memories of Rizwanur Rahman, the computer graphics trainer who allegedly committed suicide in 2007 after being hounded by the police over his marriage to a Hindu woman. The TMC had used the case to corner the Left Front government of the time, and Mamata potentially faces a similar situation now. She can ill-afford the Anis Khan case being used by political opponents to mobilise Muslims, who make up a third of Bengal's 100 million population and have sizeable numbers in 100 assembly seats.

'*Bhulte pari amar naam, bhulbo nako Anis Khan* (We can forget our names but not Anis Khan's)'. This slogan reverberating at the February 19 protest by hundreds of Aliah University students in the heart of Kolkata sums up the mood against the Mamata government: justice for Anis Khan and nothing less. ■

FORM-IV

Place of Publication:	New Delhi
Periodicity of Publication:	Weekly
Printer's Name:	Manoj Sharma
Nationality:	Indian
Address:	A-3/723, Tower-8, Silver City, Sector-93, Noida-201 301, Uttar Pradesh
Publisher's Name:	Manoj Sharma
Nationality:	Indian
Address:	A-3/723, Tower-8, Silver City, Sector-93, Noida-201 301, Uttar Pradesh
Editor's Name:	Raj Chengappa
Nationality:	Indian
Address:	C-31, Defence Colony, New Delhi-110 021.

Names and Addresses of individuals who own the newspaper and partners or shareholders holding more than one per cent of the total capital:

Owner: M/s. Living Media India Limited, F26, Ist Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi – 110 001.

Shareholders holding more than one per cent of the total capital of the owner company:

1. Mr. Aroon Purie, 6, Palam Marg, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi-110 057.
2. Mrs. Rekha Purie, 6, Palam Marg, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi-110 057.
3. Mr. Ankoor Purie, 6, Palam Marg, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi-110 057.
4. Mrs. Koel Purie Rinchet, 6, Palam Marg, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi-110 057.
5. Mrs. Kalli Purie Bhandal, 6, Palam Marg, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi-110 057.
6. World Media Private Limited, F26, Ist Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi – 110 001.
7. IGH Holdings Private Limited, 1st Floor, Industry House, 159 Churchgate Reclamation, Mumbai- 400 020.

I, Manoj Sharma, hereby declare that the particulars given above are true to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Sd/-

Manoj Sharma

Date: 01.03.2022 Signature of Publisher